

Corel Photo-Paint X3



Straight Lines And Steps

When using any brush tool in Photo-Paint (paint, eraser, image sprayer and so on), hold down [Ctrl] to paint along a straight line. To switch directions from horizontal to vertical and vice-versa, hold [Shift], and then release [Shift] to get back to your original direction. Try using this to draw stairs—hold down [Ctrl] and move diagonally; hit [Shift] every time you want a step.

Quickly Select All Objects

To select all the objects (Corel's equivalent of Photoshop's Layers) in your image, just double-click the object pick tool (the first one on the left-hand toolbar) and all the objects will be selected at once.

This is an issue of some debate—some people have reported faster browsing speeds by increasing the value from 0. You'll therefore need to experiment. First try 0, then try something else.

Zooming Fun

To instantly restore the image's zoom level to 100 per cent, just double-click the zoom icon. And to enable Interactive Zoom, hold down [Alt] and the mouse button and move the mouse around to zoom in and out.

Make Your Own Image Sprayers

The Image Sprayer tool is one of Photo-Paint's most fun features—especially when you want to scatter a bunch of objects on your images—notes, leaves, garbage, you name it. To create your own image sprayer, you will need (naturally), a few images, preferably with no background colours. If they do have backgrounds, you'll need to use either the Magic Wand tool (W), Cutout Lab (explained later) or any of the other selection tools to cut them out of their

backgrounds. Once you've done that, bring all these images together in one file as separate objects. Use the object picker (O) and hold down [Shift] while clicking on all the objects to select them all. Select the Image Sprayer and open the Brush Settings docker from **Window > Dockers > Brush Settings**. Click on the arrow at the top-right corner and select **Save Objects as Image List** from the menu. Voila—your own image sprayer!

Quick Mirror Objects

To flip objects horizontally or vertically while working, just select the object picker (O) and select the Scale Mode button from the toolbar on top. Now with [Ctrl] held down, click one of the object's handles and drag to flip it along that axis.

Crazy Characters

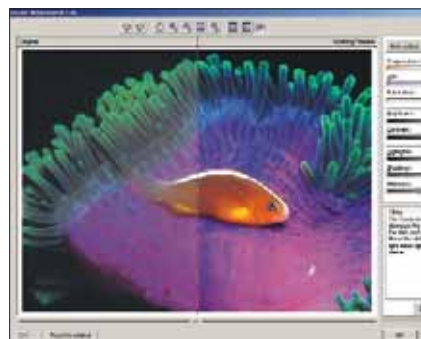
A nifty new feature in Photo-Paint X3 is the ability to move and rotate individual characters for some cool text effects. Select the text tool (T) and on the toolbar that appears on the top of the workspace, click on the "F" icon to



open the Character Formatting docker. You will find the aforementioned effects under Character Shift. Select individual characters and rotate them or move them vertically or horizontally as you please! The text remains editable, so you can change it any time you like.

To The Lab!

For finer control over tweaking images, you can now use the new Image Adjustment Lab. Select **Adjust > Image Adjustment Lab** to start it. You can adjust colour temperature to give the



Tweak images in the Image Adjustment Lab



Create your own image sprayers

whites a warm, yellowish tinge, or make it cooler to give it a bluish tinge. If the image is a little lacklustre, your best bet is to brighten the highlights and midtones.

To fix a dark image, brighten the shadows, and to add intensity to a washed out image, darken them. To see a "before-and-after" view of the image, click on the **Before and After Split Preview** button on the extreme right of the toolbar. You can even define the split by dragging the boundary between the two pictures.

Cut It Out

If you've ever used Photoshop's Extract filter, you can appreciate how important it is to be able to cut out objects from their backgrounds—especially ones without clearly defined edges—the fur of an animal, for instance. Now even Photo-Paint X3 has an answer to this—the Cutout Lab.

You will find this under **Image > Cutout Lab**. Use the Highlight tool to draw a rough border around the object you want to extract, fill the area with the Inside Fill tool and hit Preview to see what the result will look like.

Under Cutout results, select **Cutout** for a simple cutout, **Cutout and Original Image** to preserve the original image and make a cutout in a new object, and finally **Cutout as Clip Mask** that creates a mask for that layer which you can edit later.

Use The Interactive Tools

Whether it's drop shadows or gradual transparency, Photo-Paint offers you interactive tools for both—just click and drag to start with the effect, and you can now use sliders right there to adjust the settings. The Interactive drop shadow tool lets you adjust the Feather (the fuzziness of the edges) of the shadow and its transparency. The interactive object transparency tool lets you adjust the mid-point of the gradient.